

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1405

By Powell

A RESOLUTION to honor and celebrate the Spain Men's National Team for selecting the State of Tennessee and the City of Chattanooga to host its group phase base camp and training site for the 2026 World Cup.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly are pleased to commend a global sporting event that will contribute significantly to Tennessee's economy while entertaining soccer fans worldwide; and

WHEREAS, the Spain Men's National Team will use the Baylor School's soccer complex in Chattanooga as its team base camp and training site in preparation for the group phase of the FIFA 2026 World Cup this summer; and

WHEREAS, additionally, the Spain's Men's National Team and members of the Real Federación Española de Fútbol (RFEF) delegation will reside in downtown Chattanooga as the squad prepares for the opening round of the World Cup; and

WHEREAS, RFEF ultimately selected Baylor as Spain's training site because of the school's superior campus facilities and its infrastructure to support elite athletic performance; and

WHEREAS, Baylor provides the necessary privacy and security for Spain to prepare for the World Cup without distraction, and for logistical purposes, Chattanooga is a mere ninety minutes from Atlanta, Georgia, where La Roja will play two of its group stage matches; and

WHEREAS, winning RFEF's approval for the Baylor School to serve as the Spain Men's National Team base camp and training site required the hard work, collaboration, and vision of a partnership that included Baylor, Vision Hospitality Group, Hamilton County, and the Sports and Events Corporation; and

WHEREAS, Baylor's selection is not only an honor, but it also solidifies Chattanooga's reputation as a serious destination for fans of the beautiful game and extends its legacy as an accomplished host of world-class soccer; and

WHEREAS, there is also an important economic component to Chattanooga hosting a base camp and training site for Spain, the FIFA top-ranked team in the world and the favorite to win the 2026 World Cup; and

WHEREAS, according to an analysis prepared for San Antonio, Texas's World Cup planning by Market Edge, non-host U.S. cities serving as an official FIFA training hub are projected to generate between \$5 million and \$15 million from a base camp arrangement; and

WHEREAS, the University of Tennessee will play an important role in the success of the first World Cup held on American soil since 1994; and

WHEREAS, because of its renowned turfgrass management program, the University of Tennessee was selected by FIFA to create the best natural grass playing surfaces at all sixteen host cities and dozens of training facilities across the U.S., Canada, and Mexico; and

WHEREAS, it is indeed exciting that the world's greatest sporting event is being contested on American soil this summer; it is equally exciting that the State of Tennessee, the City of Chattanooga, and Hamilton County will play an important role in making the 2026 World Cup an event to cherish and remember; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and celebrate La Roja, the Spain Men's National Team, and the Real Federación Española de Fútbol for selecting the State of Tennessee and the City of Chattanooga to host its group phase base camp and training site for the 2026 World Cup and extend to them our warmest welcome to the Volunteer State and the Scenic City.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.